WHAT LIES BEHIND THE GHOST VILLAGES

IN UTTARAKHAND'S REMOTE HILLS, OUTMIGRATION HAS REACHED CRISIS LEVELS. WITH VILLAGES EMPTYING OUT, THE GOVERNMENT HAS BEEN SPOOKED INTO ACTION

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Photographs by ARUN KUMAR



758
No. of 'ghost villages' in Uttarakhand

690,000
No. of people who have left the state for work/ temporarily (2011-'22); 147,000 have moved out permanently in the same period